

Chapter 4: Budget & Cost Management

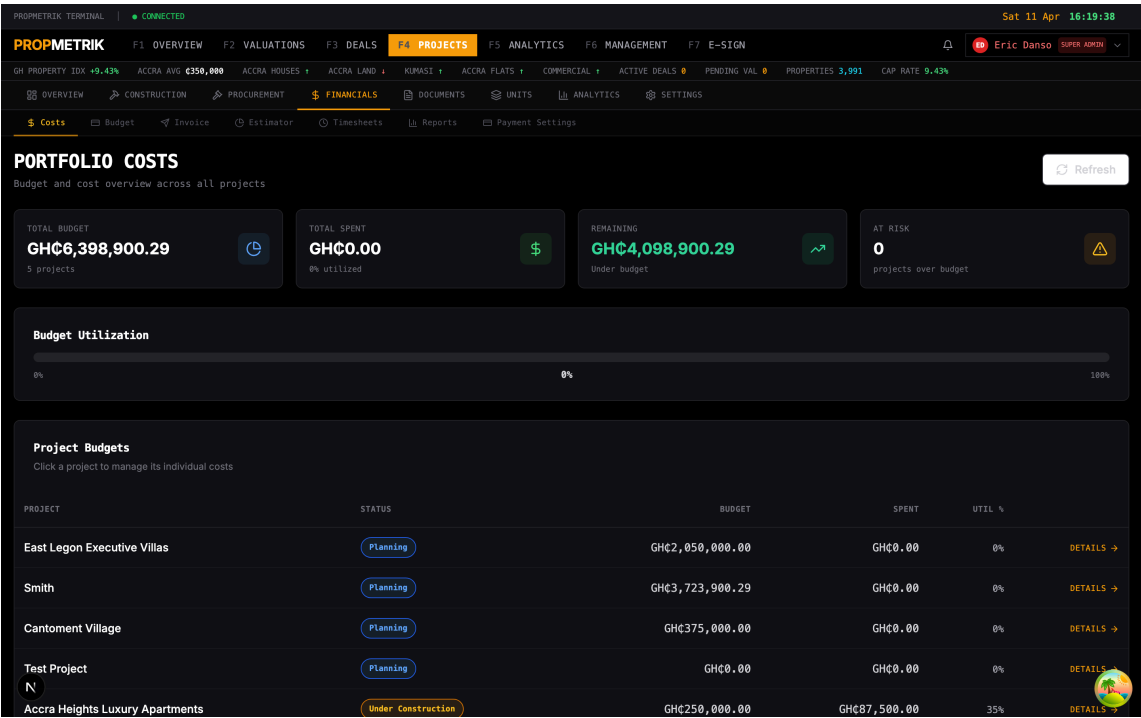
Overview

The Budget & Cost Management module in PropMetrik gives project managers and finance teams full visibility into construction budgets, cost tracking, invoicing, and payment schedules. Accessible from the project sub-navigation under **Budget & Cost**, it ties directly into each project and provides real-time summaries of budgeted amounts, committed spend, actuals, and variances -- all denominated in Ghanaian Cedis (GHS) by default.

This module is designed for construction and development projects where cost control is critical. It supports 19 cost categories spanning the full development lifecycle, from land acquisition through marketing and sales, and tracks each line item through a clear status workflow: Draft, Budgeted, Committed, Invoiced, Approved, Paid, or Cancelled.

4.1 Costs Overview

Navigate to your project and select **Budget & Cost** from the project sub-navigation bar.



Summary Cards

At the top of the page, four summary cards provide an at-a-glance financial snapshot:

Card	Description
Total Budget	The sum of all revised budgets (or original budgets where no revision exists) across every cost line item

Committed	Total amount that has been committed to vendors or contractors, shown with percentage of total budget
Spent	Actual expenditure to date, with a utilization percentage
Variance	Difference between budget and actual spend. Displayed in green when under budget or red when over budget

Budget Breakdown by Category

Below the summary cards, the **Overview** tab shows a horizontal bar chart for each cost category. Each bar displays:

- The category name (e.g., Foundation, Structural, MEP)
- The percentage of budget consumed
- A progress bar that turns red when spending exceeds 100% of the budgeted amount

PropMetrik supports the following cost categories:

- Land Acquisition
- Permits & Approvals
- Design & Engineering
- Site Preparation
- Foundation
- Structural
- Roofing
- MEP (Mechanical/Electrical/Plumbing)
- Exterior Finishing
- Interior Finishing
- Landscaping
- Amenities
- Contingency
- Professional Fees
- Insurance
- Marketing & Sales
- Legal
- Financing Costs
- Other

4.2 Adding a Cost Item

1. Click the **Add Cost** button (amber, top-right corner) on the Budget & Cost page.
2. In the dialog that appears, fill in the required fields:
 - **Description** -- A clear name for this cost item (e.g., "Substructure Concrete Works")
 - **Category** -- Select from the dropdown of 19 categories
 - **Original Budget** -- The budgeted amount in your project currency
 - **Notes** (optional) -- Any additional context or justification
3. Click **Save** to add the cost item.

The new item will appear in the **Cost Items** tab with a default status of Draft.

Cost Item Status Workflow

Each cost item progresses through the following statuses:

Status	Meaning
Draft	Initial entry, not yet approved for budget
Budgeted	Approved and included in the project budget
Committed	A purchase order or contract has been issued
Invoiced	An invoice has been received from the vendor
Approved	The invoice has been approved for payment
Paid	Payment has been disbursed
Cancelled	The cost item has been removed or voided

4.3 Cost Items Table

Switch to the **Cost Items** tab to view all line items in a detailed table.

Filtering and Search

Use the controls above the table to narrow results:

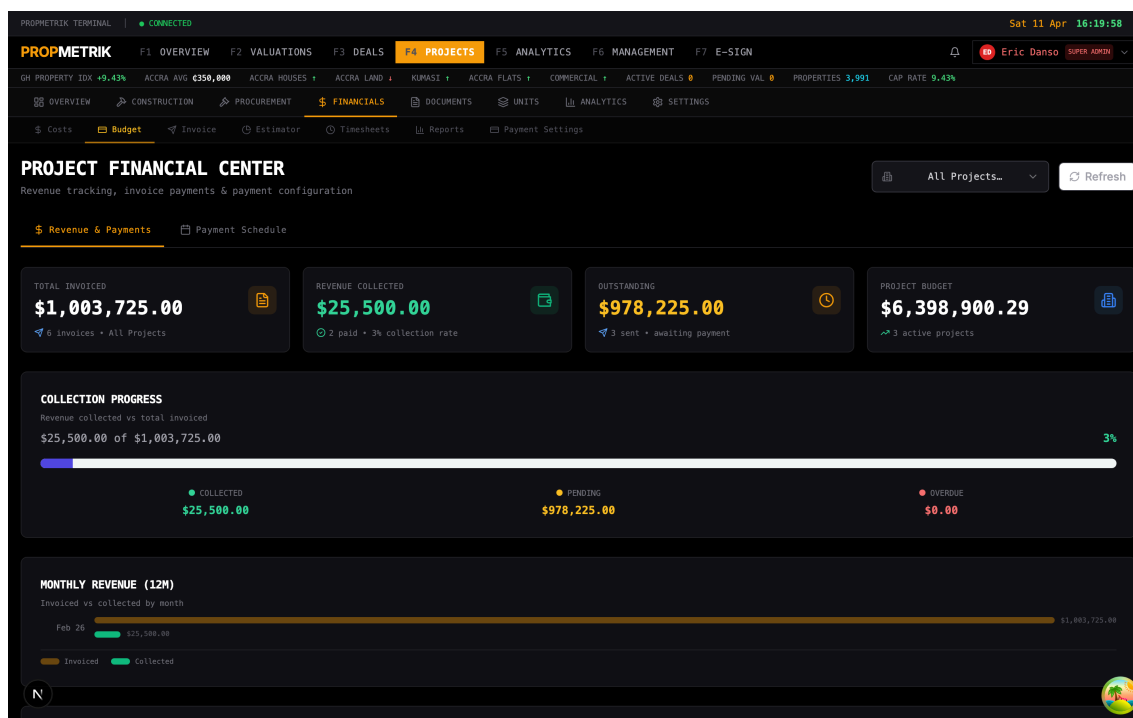
- **Search** -- Type a keyword to filter by description
- **Category dropdown** -- Filter by any of the 19 cost categories
- **Status dropdown** -- Filter by Draft, Budgeted, Committed, Invoiced, Approved, Paid, or Cancelled

Table Columns

Column	Description
Description	The cost item name
Category	The assigned cost category
Status	Current status badge with color coding
Budgeted	The revised budget (or original if no revision)
Actual	Actual costs recorded to date
Variance	Budget minus actual -- red if negative, green if positive

4.4 Financials

The **Financials** tab provides aggregated financial reporting for the project.



Key features include:

- **Cash flow visualization** -- Monthly income vs. expenditure charted over time
- **Budget vs. actual comparison** -- Side-by-side comparison across all categories
- **Cumulative spend tracking** -- Running total of expenditure against the budget ceiling
- **Xero integration status** -- If connected, shows sync status for costs pushed to Xero accounting

Tip: Connect your Xero account from the project settings to automatically sync cost data with your accounting software. See Chapter 10 for Xero integration setup.

4.5 Invoices

The Invoices section tracks all vendor invoices associated with the project.

PROPMETRIK TERMINAL

CONNECTED

Sat 11 Apr 16:20:18

PROPMETRIK

F1 OVERVIEW

F2 VALUATIONS

F3 DEALS

F4 PROJECTS

F5 ANALYTICS

F6 MANAGEMENT

F7 E-SIGN

GH PROPERTY IDX +9.43%

ACCRA AVG ₵350,000

ACCRA HOUSES +

ACCRA LAND +

KUMASI +

ACCRA FLATS +

COMMERCIAL +

ACTIVE DEALS 0

PENDING VAL 0

PROPERTIES 3,991

CAP RATE 9.43%

OVERVIEW

CONSTRUCTION

PROCUREMENT

FINANCIALS

DOCUMENTS

UNITS

ANALYTICS

SETTINGS

Summary

Team

INVOICES

Create, track and manage project invoices with approval workflows

PROJECT: East Legon Executive Villas

Total Invoiced
GH₵478,125.00

Paid
GH₵0.00
No payments yet

Pending
GH₵478,125.00
Awaiting payment

Overdue
GH₵0.00
None overdue

Search Invoices...

All Status

New Invoice

Invoice #	Vendor	Amount ₵	Due Date ₵	Status
INV-2026-001		GH₵425,000.00	10 Apr 2026	Pending

N

Viewing Invoices

The invoice list displays:

- Invoice number and vendor name
- Issue date and due date
- Amount in project currency
- Payment status (Pending, Paid, Overdue)

Creating an Invoice

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PROPMETRIK

F1 OVERVIEW

F2 VALUATIONS

F3 DEALS

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F6 MANAGEMENT

F7 E-SIGN

GH PROPERTY IDX +9.43%

ACCRA AVG c350,000

ACCRA HOUSES +

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KUMASI +

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ACTIVE DEALS 0

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OVERVIEW

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SETTINGS

Costs

Budget

Invoice

Estimator

Timesheets

Reports

Payment Settings

INVOICE BUILDER

CREATE · SEND · TRACK · BLOCKCHAIN-SECURED INVOICING

DRAFT

INVOICE HEADER

INVOICE NUMBER

INV-2026-7737

CURRENCY

GHS - Ghana Cedi

INVOICE DATE

04/11/2026

DUE DATE

05/11/2026

PAYMENT TERMS

Net 30

PROJECT DETAILS

PROJECT

PHASE

CONTRACT TYPE

Select project...

Construction

Lump Sum

BILL FROM

PROPMETRIK GROUP

Address

eric@cedynhq.com

BILL TO

Client Name *

Address

Email *

PROPMETRIK

REAL ESTATE INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM

INVOICE

DRAFT

INVOICE NUMBER

DATE

DUE DATE

TERMS

INV-2026-7737

10 Apr 2026

10 May 2026

Net 30

FROM

BILL TO

PROPMETRIK GROUP

—

eric@cedynhq.com

#	DESCRIPTION	QTY	UNIT	RATE	AMOUNT
1	Other	0	Item	GHS0.00	GHS0.00
Subtotal					GHS0.00
PROPMETRIK Fee (0.25%)					GHS0.00
TOTAL DUE					GHS0.00

Paystack processing fees charged separately at checkout

NOTES

Payment preferred via Paystack or bank transfer. Mobile money accepted.

TERMS & CONDITIONS

Payment is due within 30 days of invoice date. Late payments attract a 1.5% monthly surcharge as per the Ghana Consumer Protection Act 2006. All amounts are in Ghana Cedis unless otherwise stated.

Save Draft

Download PDF

Duplicate

Void

SEND INVOICE

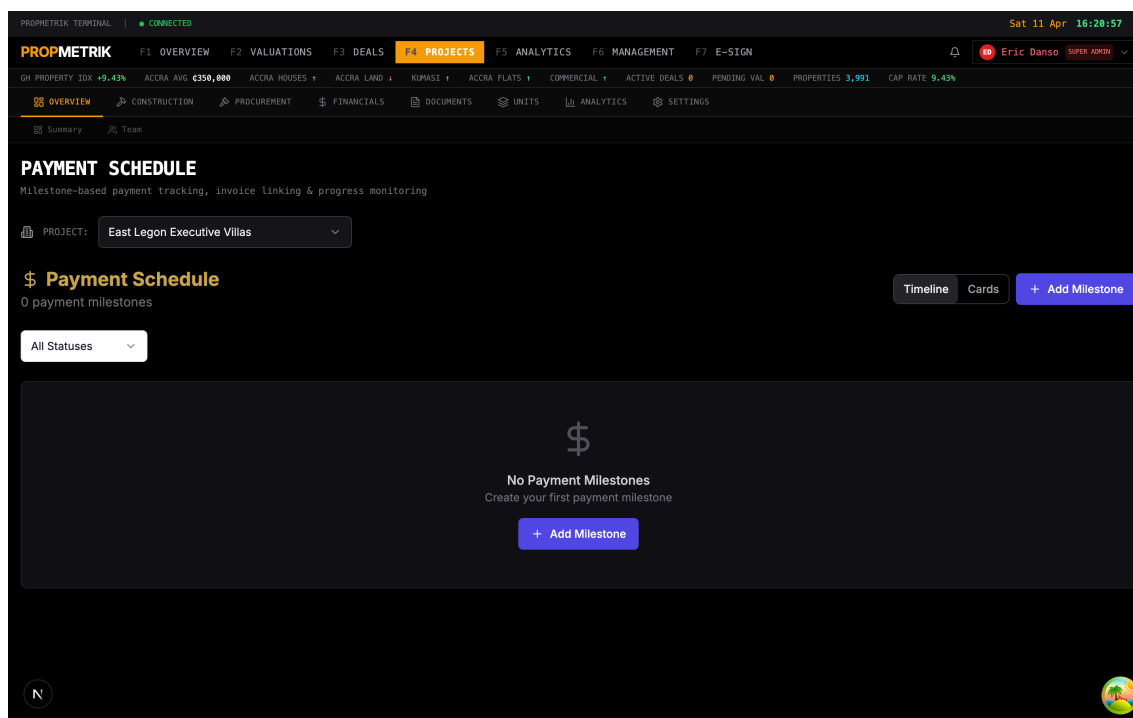
To create a new invoice:

1. Click **New Invoice** from the Invoices tab.
2. Select the vendor or contractor.
3. Add line items with descriptions, quantities, unit prices, and tax rates.
4. The system calculates subtotals, tax, and the grand total automatically.
5. Set the payment terms and due date.
6. Click **Create Invoice** to save.

Invoices can be linked to specific cost items, ensuring that actual spend is recorded against the correct budget line.

4.6 Payment Schedule

The Payment Schedule provides a timeline view of upcoming and completed payments.



How It Works

- Payments are organized by milestone or date
- Each entry shows the payee, amount, due date, and status
- Overdue payments are highlighted for immediate attention
- The schedule can be filtered by status (Upcoming, Paid, Overdue)

This view is particularly useful for cash flow planning and ensuring that contractors are paid on time according to contractual milestones.

4.7 Payment Settings

Configure payment preferences and integration settings from the Payment Settings panel.

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PROPMETRIK F1 OVERVIEW F2 VALUATIONS F3 DEALS **F4 PROJECTS** F5 ANALYTICS F6 MANAGEMENT F7 E-SIGN F8 ADMIN ADMIN

Loading market data...

OVERVIEW CONSTRUCTION PROCUREMENT **FINANCIALS** DOCUMENTS UNITS ANALYTICS SETTINGS

Costs Budget Invoice Estimator Timesheets Reports **Payment Settings**

PAYMENT SETTINGS

Configure payment methods, currencies & processing options

PAYOUT ACCOUNT

Where project payments are deposited VERIFIED

METHOD	BANK
Bank Transfer	MTN
ACCOUNT	ACCOUNT NAME
024****310	FRANCIS NKETIAH
SERVICE FEE	CONFIGURED
max(0.25%, GHS 25.00)	08/03/2026

☐ Buyer payments are automatically split: you receive the principal, PROPMETRIK retains the service fee. UPDATE

CONFIGURE CRYPTO PAYOUT

Choose your payout currency and enter your wallet address

Select which currency you want to receive project payments in. Clients can pay with any coin – it will be auto-converted to your chosen currency.

1. PAYOUT CURRENCY *

Select your payout currency...

N SAVE PAYOUT 

Available settings include:

- **Default currency** -- Set the project currency (GHS, USD, GBP, EUR)
- **Payment terms** -- Define standard payment terms (Net 15, Net 30, Net 60)
- **Bank details** -- Configure disbursement account information
- **Approval workflow** -- Set thresholds for payment approval levels
- **Notification preferences** -- Configure alerts for overdue invoices and upcoming payments

Tips and Best Practices

1. **Set budgets early.** Enter all cost categories with their budgeted amounts at project inception. This establishes the baseline for variance tracking throughout the project lifecycle.
2. **Use the status workflow consistently.** Move cost items through the status pipeline (Draft to Budgeted to Committed to Paid) to maintain an accurate picture of financial commitments.
3. **Review variances weekly.** The Variance card on the overview page provides immediate visibility into budget overruns. Address red-flagged categories before they escalate.
4. **Link invoices to cost items.** When entering vendor invoices, always associate them with the correct cost line item. This ensures the "Actual" column reflects real spend.
5. **Plan cash flow with the Payment Schedule.** Use the milestone-based payment schedule to forecast upcoming disbursements and avoid liquidity crunches.
6. **Leverage Xero sync.** If your organization uses Xero, connect it to avoid double-entry of financial data. Cost items synced to Xero will show a sync status indicator.
7. **Use contingency wisely.** Budget a contingency line item (typically 5-10% of total budget) and monitor it separately. Avoid using contingency for planned scope changes -- those should be

tracked as change orders.

Navigation Reference

Action	Path
Open Budget & Cost	Project > Sub-nav > Budget & Cost
Add a cost item	Budget & Cost > Add Cost button
View cost details	Budget & Cost > Cost Items tab > Click row
Create an invoice	Budget & Cost > Invoices tab > New Invoice
View payment schedule	Budget & Cost > Payment Schedule tab
Configure settings	Budget & Cost > Payment Settings tab